MOCK TEST 32

📖 READING

5 parts · 35 questions

⏱ 60 minutes

Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.

PART 1

Questions 1–6

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

ELECTIONS AND DISINFORMATION IN 2024

The year 2024 will be the biggest ever year for voting. National elections will take place in around 64 countries, as well as in the European Union. An estimated two billion people - almost half the global population - could **Q1**_____ at some time this year. The results of these polls will bring big changes for the future of many **Q2**_____. Voters in the world's four largest electoral blocs - the EU, India, Indonesia and the USA - will be casting their votes.

One of the first contests will be in Taiwan on January the 13th. For much of the **Q3**_____, eyes will be focused on events in the US. In November, there will be a repeat of the 2020 election if Donald Trump runs for President again.

Journalists are worried about how free and fair many **Q4** _____ will be. The website Bloomberg.com has already posed a question that is on the lips of many people. It asked: "Will 2024 be the year fake news destroys democracy?" Bloomberg said bad actors will use artificial intelligence to change the way people vote via fake **Q5**_____ articles. It said there will be "a storm of disinformation". It added that **Q6** _____ has already begun to spread, and that this "gets harder to spot as fake with every passing month".

PART 2

Questions 7–14

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use.

A) You are seeking a tropical retreat.

B) You want a fun-filled family getaway.

C) You want to relax and relieve your stress.

D) You want to enjoy doing something that's fun and active.

E) You need to relax doing a sport that requires attention and fun.

F) You are freshly married. You want to go somewhere for you and your wife.

G) You want to explore and know about nature as well as doing some outdoor activities.

H) You want an expensive and qualified rest.

I) Your librarian friend wants to go somewhere. He would like to see places he only sees from books.

J) You and your friends want to go there to escape from summer as well as doing some extreme sports.

7

Q7

SPA AND WELLNESS RETREAT: Indulge in a tranquil oasis dedicated to rejuvenation and self-care. Our resort offers luxurious spa treatments, yoga classes, and serene surroundings. Unwind and restore your mind, body, and soul in our haven of bliss.

8

Q8

COUPLES' RETREAT: Escape the hustle and bustle of everyday life and immerse yourself in a romantic haven for two. Our adults-only resort offers private villas, candlelit dinners, and secluded beaches. Rediscover love in a picturesque setting.

9

Q9

FIVE-STAR RESORT AND SPA: Experience the epitome of luxury at our opulent resort. Indulge in lavish accommodations, Michelin-starred dining, and a world-class spa. Immerse yourself in a world of sophistication and unparalleled service.

10

Q10

HISTORIC RESORT: Step back in time and experience the rich cultural heritage of our historic resort. Located in a restored mansion or castle, our resort offers a unique blend of old-world charm and modern amenities. Immerse yourself in the stories of the past.

11

Q11

ALL-INCLUSIVE FAMILY RESORT: Create lifelong memories with your loved ones at our family-friendly resort. From kids' clubs to thrilling water parks, we have activities for all ages. Enjoy spacious accommodations and a variety of dining options. Book now for an unforgettable family adventure!

12

Q12

ECO-LODGE IN THE WILDERNESS: Immerse yourself in the beauty of nature at our eco-lodge, nestled in a pristine natural reserve. Explore hiking trails, spot exotic wildlife, and bask in the serenity of untouched landscapes. Unplug and reconnect with the great outdoors.

13

Q13

ALPINE SKI RESORT: Hit the slopes and embrace the winter wonderland at our alpine ski resort. Enjoy world-class skiing and snowboarding, cozy chalet accommodations, and après-ski activities. Gather around the fireplace and create memories in the snow.

14

Q14

EXOTIC ISLAND RESORT: Escape to a secluded paradise nestled among palm-fringed beaches and crystal-clear waters. Our resort offers luxury villas, world-class amenities, and a range of water activities. Your dream vacation awaits!

PART 3

Questions 15–20

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

A song for getting porridge
B) Surprising use of school premises
C) Global perspective
D) Surprising academics outcome
E) Girls are specially treated in the program
F) How food program is operated
G) How food program affects school attendance
H) None of the usual reasons

15. Paragraph I **16. Paragraph II** **17. Paragraph III**
18. Paragraph IV **19. Paragraph V** **20. Paragraph VI**

SCHOOL FEEDING AND EDUCATION IN MALAWI

I. There are not enough classrooms at the Msekeni primary school, so half the lessons take place in the shade of yellow-blossomed acacia trees. Given this shortage, it might seem odd that one classroom has been emptied and turned into a storeroom for sacks of grain. But it makes sense. Food matters more than shelter.

II. Msekeni is in one of the poorer parts of Malawi, a landlocked southern African country of exceptional beauty and great poverty. No war lays waste Malawi, nor is the land unusually eroded or infertile, but Malawians still have trouble finding enough to eat. Half of the children under five are underfed to the point of stunting. Hunger blights most aspects of Malawian life, so the country is as good a place as any to investigate how nutrition affects development, and vice versa.

III. The headmaster at Msekeni, Bernard Kumanda, has strong views on the subject. He thinks food is a priceless teaching aid. Since 1999, his pupils have received free school lunches. Donors such as the World Food Programme provide the food: those sacks of grain in that converted classroom. Local volunteers do the cooking - turning the dry ingredients into a bland but nutritious slop and spooning it out on to plastic plates. The children line up in large crowds, cheerfully singing a song called "We are getting porridge".

IV. When the school's feeding programme was introduced, enrolment at Msekeni doubled. Some of the new pupils had switched from nearby schools that did not give out free porridge, but most were children whose families had previously kept them at home to work. These families were so poor that the long-term benefits of education seemed unattractive when setting against the short-term gain of sending children out to gather firewood or help in the fields. One plate of porridge a day completely altered the calculation. A child fed at school will not howl so plaintively for food at home. Girls, who are more likely than boys to be kept out of school, are given extra snacks to take home.

V. When a school takes in a horde of extra students from the poorest homes, you would expect standards to drop. Anywhere in the world, poor kids tend to perform worse than their better-off classmates. When the influx of new pupils is not accompanied by an increase in the number of teachers, as was the case at Msekeni, you would expect standards to fall even further. But they have not. Pass rates at Msekeni improved dramatically, from 30% to 85%. Although this was an exceptional example, the nationwide results of school feeding programmes were still pretty good. On average, after a Malawian school started handing out free food it attracted 38% more girls and 24% more boys. The pass rate for boys stayed about the same, while for girls it improved by 9.5%.

VI. On a global scale, the good news is that people are eating better than ever before. Homo sapiens has grown 50% bigger since the industrial revolution. Three centuries ago, chronic malnutrition was more or less universal. Now, it is extremely rare in rich countries. In developing countries, where most people live, plates and rice bowls are all fuller than ever before. The proportion of children under five in the developing world who are malnourished to the point of stunting fell from 39% in 1990 to 30% in 2000, says the World Health Organisation (WHO). In other places, the battle against hunger is steadily being won. Better nutrition is making people cleverer and more energetic, which will help them grow more prosperous. And when they eventually join the ranks of the well off, they can start fretting about growing too fast.

PART 4

Questions 21–29

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

CAUSES OF OVERPOPULATION

Firstly it is decline in the Death Rate: At the root of overpopulation is the difference between the overall birth rate and death rate in populations. If the number of children born each year equals the number of adults that die, then the population will stabilize. Talking about overpopulation shows that while there are many factors that can increase the death rate for short periods of time, the ones that increase the birth rate do so over a long period of time. The discovery of agriculture by our ancestors was one factor that provided them with the ability to sustain their nutrition without hunting. This created the first imbalance between the two rates.

Following this came the industrial revolution and better Medical Facilities. Technological advancement was perhaps the biggest reason why the balance has been permanently disturbed.

Science was able to produce better means of producing food, which allowed families to feed more mouths. Medical science made many discoveries thanks to which they were able to defeat a whole range of diseases. Illnesses that had claimed thousands of lives till now were cured because of the invention of vaccines. Combining the increase in food supply with fewer means of mortality tipped the balance and became the starting point of overpopulation.

However, when talking about overpopulation we should understand that there is a psychological component as well. For thousands of years, a very small part of the population had enough money to live in comfort. The rest faced poverty and would give birth to large families to make up for the high infant mortality rate. Families that have been through poverty, natural disasters or are simply in need of more hands to work are a major factor for overpopulation. As compared to earlier times, most of these extra children survive and consume resources that are not sufficient in nature. With latest technological advancement and more discoveries in medical science particularly in Fertility Treatment, it has become possible for couples who are unable to conceive to undergo fertility treatment methods and have their own babies. Today there are effective medicines which can increases the chance of conception and lead to rise in birth rate. Moreover, due to modern techniques pregnancies today are far safer.

Another cause of overpopulation is immigration. Many people prefer to move to developed countries like US, UK, Canada and Australia where best facilities are available in terms of medical, education, security and employment. The end result is that those people settle over there and those places become overcrowded. Difference between the number of people who are leaving the country and the number of people who enter narrows down which leads to more demand for food, clothes, energy and homes. This gives rise to shortage of resources. Though the overall population remains the same, it just affects the density of population making that place simply overcrowded.

The last thing that affects overpopulation is lack of Family Planning. Most developing nations have large number of people who are illiterate, live below the poverty line and have little or no knowledge about family planning. Getting their children married at an early age increase the chances of producing more kids. Those people are unable to understand the harmful effects of overpopulation and lack of quality education prompts them to avoid family planning measures.

Choose the correct letter A, B, C or D.

21 What created the first imbalance between the overall birth rate and death rate in populations?

A) The discovery of medicals.
B) Talking about overpopulation.
C) Talking about ecological problems.
D) The discovery of agriculture by our ancestors.

22 What did medical science do?

A) Produced better means of producing food.
B) Combined the increase in food supply with fewer means of mortality.
C) Made many discoveries which were able to defeat a whole range of diseases.
D) Increased the industrial revolution.

23 To what did it lead when families in poverty gave birth to large families?

A) It led to psychological component.
B) They made up high infant mortality rate.
C) It led to the need of more hands to work.
D) It led to consumption of resources.

24 What does changing the place of living affect?

A) It affects the density of population.
B) It makes the place simply overcrowded.
C) It leads to more demand for food, clothes, energy and homes.
D) It gives rise to shortage of resources.

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text.

25 The discovery of agriculture allowed our ancestors to satisfy their hunger without hunting.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

26 Human progress is the biggest reason why birth and death rates doesn't differ nowadays.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

27 For thousands of years, people had less children while nowadays, they are born more and more.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

28 Many people from UK, USA and Australia fear that they will have to leave because of overcrowding.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

29 When the vaccine invented and other medical advancements were made, overpopulation issue simultaneously started to become an issue.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

PART 5 Questions 30–35

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

MAMMOTH KILL 2

Like their modern relatives, mammoths were quite large. The largest known species reached heights in the region of 4 m at the shoulder and weighs up to 8 tonnes, while exceptionally large males may have exceeded 12 tonnes. However, most species of mammoth were only about as large as a modern Asian elephant. Both sexes bore tusks. A first, small set appeared at about the age of six months and these were replaced at about 18 months by the permanent set. Growth of the permanent set was at a rate of about 1 to 6 inches by year. Based on studies of their close relatives, the modern elephants, mammoths probably had a gestation period of 22 months, resulting in a single calf being born. Their social structure was probably the same as that of African and Asian elephants, with

females living in herds headed by a matriarch, whilst bulls lived solitary lives or formed loose groups after sexual maturity.

MEXICO CITY - Although it's hard to imagine in this age of urban sprawl and automobiles, North America once belonged to mammoths, camels, ground sloths as large as cows, bear-sized beavers and other formidable beasts. Some 11,000 years ago, however, these large-bodied mammals and others - about 70 species in all - disappeared. Their demise coincided roughly with the arrival of humans in the New World and dramatic climatic change - factors that have inspired several theories about the die-off. Yet despite decades of scientific investigation, the exact cause remains a mystery. Now new findings offer support to one of these controversial hypotheses: that human hunting drove this megafaunal menagerie to extinction. The overkill model emerged in the 1960s when it was put forth by Paul S. Martin of the University of Arizona. Since then, critics have charged that no evidence exists to support the idea that the first Americans hunted to the extent necessary to cause these extinctions. But at the annual meeting of the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology in Mexico City last October, paleoecologist John Alroy of the University of California at Santa Barbara argued that, in fact, hunting-driven extinction is not only plausible, but it was only unavoidable. He has determined, using a computer simulation, which even a very modest amount of hunting would have wiped these animals out.

Assuming an initial human population of 100 people that grew no more than 2 percent annually, Alroy determined that if each band of, say, 50 people killed 15 to 20 large mammals a year, humans could have eliminated the animal populations within 1,000 years. Large mammals, in particular, would have been vulnerable to the pressure because they have longer gestation periods than smaller mammals and they're young require extended care.

Not everyone agrees with Alroy's assessment. For one, the results depend in part on population-size estimates for the extinct animals - figures that are not necessarily reliable. But a more specific criticism comes from mammalogist Ross D. E. MacPhee of the American Museum of Natural History in New York City, who points out that the relevant archaeological record contains barely a dozen examples of stone points embedded in mammoth bones (and none, it should be noted, are known from other megafaunal remains) - hardly what one might expect if hunting drove these animals to extinction. Furthermore, some of these species had huge ranges - the giant Jefferson's ground sloth, for example, lived as far north as the Yukon and as far south as Mexico - which would have made slaughtering them in numbers sufficient to cause their extinction rather implausible, he says.

Macphee agrees that humans most likely brought about these extinctions (as well as others around the world that coincided with human arrival), but not directly. Rather he suggests that people may have introduced hyper lethal disease, perhaps through their dogs or hitchhiking vermin, which then spread wildly among the immunologically naive species of the New World. As in the overkill model, populations of large mammals would have a harder time recovering. Repeated outbreaks of a hyper disease could thus quickly drive them to the point of no return. So far MacPhee does not have empirical evidence for the hyper disease hypotheses, and it won't be easy to come by hyper lethal disease would kill far too quickly to leave its signature on the bones themselves. But he hopes that analyses of tissue and DNA from the last mammoths to perish will eventually reveal murderous microbes.

The third explanation for what brought on this North American extinction does not involve human beings. Instead, its proponents blame the loss on the water. The Pleistocene epoch witnessed considerable climatic instability, explains palaeontologist Russell W. Graham of the Denver Museum of Nature and Science. As a result, certain habitats disappeared, and species that had once formed communities split apart. For some animals, this change brought opportunity. For much of the megafauna, however, the increasingly homogeneous environment left them with shrinking geographical ranges - a death sentence for large animals, which need large ranges. Although these creatures managed to maintain viable populations through most of the Pleistocene, the final major fluctuation - the so-called Younger Dryas event - pushed them over the edge, Graham says.

For his part, Alroy is convinced that human hunters demolished the titans of the Ice Age. The overkill model explains everything the disease and climate scenarios explain, he asserts, and makes accurate predictions about which species would eventually go extinct. "Personally, I'm a vegetarian," he remarks, "and I find all of this kind of gross - but believable."

For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than ONE WORD and/or A NUMBER for each question.

COMPETING EXPLANATIONS FOR MAMMOTH EXTINCTION

The reason why giant mammals became extinct 11,000 years ago is under hot debate. The first explanation is that **30** _____ of human-made pressure caused it. Another assumption promoted by MacPhee is that deadly **31** _____ from human causes their demises. However, his hypothesis required more **32** _____ evidence to testify its validity. Graham proposed a third hypothesis that climatic **33** _____ in Pleistocene epoch drove some species disappear.

Choose the correct letter A, B, C or D.

34 **In this passage, Russell W. Graham argues that ...**

A) doubt raised through the study of several fossil records.
B) human hunting well explained which species would finally disappear.
C) climate shift is the main reason for extinction.
D) illness rather than hunting caused extensive extinction.

35 **In this passage, the writer ...**

A) argues that instead of hunting mammoths into extinction, they were dead on their own.
B) criticizes the role of human nature on mammoths' die-off.
C) praises the work of mammologists and other scientists on mammoth study field.
D) acknowledges the different views about mammoths' eventual extinction.

MOCK TEST 32

35 answers

1	Vote	**14**	A	**27**	Not Given / C
2	People	**15**	B	**28**	Not Given / C
3	Year	**16**	H	**29**	True / A
4	Elections	**17**	F	**30**	Hunting
5	News	**18**	G	**31**	Disease / Hyperdiseases / Hyper disease / Hyper diseases
6	Disinformation	**19**	D		
7	C	**20**	C		
8	F	**21**	D		
9	H	**22**	C	**32**	Empirical
10	I	**23**	B	**33**	Instability
11	B	**24**	A	**34**	C
12	G	**25**	True / A	**35**	D
13	J	**26**	False / B		